LENA VARGA-HOLM

Senior Data Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data engineer with 9 years of experience building and operating batch and streaming data platforms across logistics, payments and retail. Experienced in Python, SQL, Airflow, dbt, Kafka and cloud data warehouses, with a focus on reliable pipelines, data quality and dimensional modelling. AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer | Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. | 03/2022–Present

- Own ingestion and orchestration for the data platform, including approximately 140 Airflow DAGs loading data from PostgreSQL, MySQL, Salesforce and third-party APIs into Snowflake. Participate in the platform on-call rotation, one week in six.
- Migrated approximately 300 stored procedures to dbt, building over 420 models with tests on every model. Introduced incremental models and slim CI in GitHub Actions, reducing the nightly warehouse build from 5h 10m to 1h 35m.
- Introduced data contracts using JSON Schema and CI checks between product and data teams, reducing broken-pipeline incidents from approximately nine to two per month.
- Designed and built a Kafka and Snowpipe Streaming pipeline for shipment events, processing approximately 30 million events per day with p95 end-to-end latency under two minutes. Added a dead-letter topic and replay tooling for failed events.
- Replaced hourly full-table extracts of the orders database with Debezium CDC into Kafka, reducing replica CPU during loads from approximately 70% to 25%.
- Reduced monthly Snowflake costs by approximately 37% through warehouse sizing, auto-suspend and removal of unused tables.
- Mentor two data engineers and run weekly data platform office hours.

Data Engineer | Kovalent Pay | 09/2019–02/2022

- Built PySpark reconciliation jobs on AWS EMR processing approximately 1.2 TB of raw files daily from S3. Automated matching of bank settlement files to internal ledgers, reducing finance's manual reconciliation work from approximately three days to four hours per month-end.
- Designed a dimensional Redshift warehouse with more than 30 fact and dimension tables used by finance and risk.
- Set up Great Expectations data quality checks on critical finance tables.
- Developed an internal Python library for S3 and Glue Data Catalog access, used by four teams.

Junior Data Engineer / BI Developer | Adria Retail Group | 06/2017–08/2019

- Maintained SSIS packages and T-SQL ETL for an on-premises SQL Server warehouse.
- Migrated 60 nightly SSIS jobs to Python scripts scheduled with cron, making loads easier to debug and change.
- Built Power BI reports for store operations across more than 40 stores.

SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, Bash

Data platforms: Airflow, dbt, Spark (PySpark), Kafka, Kafka Connect, Debezium, Snowflake, Redshift, PostgreSQL, Great Expectations

Cloud and engineering: AWS (S3, EMR, Glue, Lambda, IAM, MSK), Docker, Terraform (basic),

GitHub Actions, CI/CD

Data modelling and quality: Dimensional modelling, data contracts, data quality testing

BI: Power BI, Looker (basic)

CERTIFICATION

AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate | May 2024

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science, Data Science track | Northgate Technical University | 2017

Thesis: Incremental materialized views for analytical queries

OPEN SOURCE AND COMMUNITY

- Contributed two merged pull requests to a community Airflow provider, fixing a pagination bug and adding tests in Python.
- Teach beginner SQL at a local women-in-tech meetup, approximately four evenings per year since 2021.
- Presented “Data contracts without the hype” at a regional data meetup in 2024.

LANGUAGES

Croatian: Native | English: C1 | German: B1